

The creator channel

Week 10, Lecture 1 · LangoBee to \$10K MRR

Summer 2026 · Operating a Solo Language App from Zero Revenue

What we'll cover

- Why language-learning YouTube is the highest-concentration watering hole
- Micro vs macro creators: the number that actually predicts results
- Market rates: CPM, flat-fee, and affiliate structures side by side
- LangoBee's unique prospecting asset: 2,773 creators already catalogued
- How the "your content is already in the app" opening line changes the math

Where the learners are

Language-learning YouTube: one watering hole

Most consumer apps have diffuse audiences. Language learners concentrate.

- Comprehensible-input learners specifically follow a small set of channels obsessively
- Dreaming Spanish alone has 1M+ subscribers; its community is methodologically uniform
- Learners who follow CI creators are already primed to consume native-level content daily
- This is the exact behavior LangoBee sells access to

One well-placed sponsored video from a mid-tier CI creator reaches more pre-qualified prospects than any Reddit launch or Show HN post.

(Rachitsky, 2022)

The difference between micro and macro

Subscriber count is a vanity metric for creator deals.

What actually predicts performance:

- **Engagement rate:** comments + likes divided by views. Micro creators (10k-100k subs) typically run 3-8%; macro (1M+) run under 1%
- **Audience specificity:** a 20k-subscriber Spanish CI channel has a more targetable audience than a 500k-subscriber general polyglot channel
- **Cost per relevant viewer:** at \$200-1,000 flat fee, a micro sponsorship costs roughly 1-5 cents per subscriber. A macro deal at \$10,000 costs the same or more per engaged viewer

For LangoBee at this stage: micro creators are the right tier.

(Influencer Marketing Hub, 2024)

Market rates: three structures

One-time cash payment per video.

No ongoing obligation. Clean, reversible.

CPM / Affiliate

Flat fee

- Nano (1k-10k subs): \$20-200
- Micro (10k-100k): \$200-1,000
- Mid-tier (100k-500k): \$1,000-10,000
- Macro (500k-1M): \$10,000-20,000
- Mega (1M+): \$20,000-50,000

(Influencer Marketing Hub, 2024)

CPM: cost per 1,000 views. Typical niche: \$15-30. Affiliate: 20-30% of each conversion attributed to the creator's link.

Break-even math: flat fee vs affiliate

LangoBee pricing: \$7.99/mo or \$49/yr. Estimated trial-to-paid conversion: 5% (no data yet; this is the floor assumption).

At a \$500 flat-fee micro sponsorship:

```
Break-even conversions = $500 / ($7.99 × 12 months × LTV multiplier)
```

```
Rough LTV at 5% monthly churn: ~$16 (2-month average)
```

```
Break-even = $500 / $16 = 32 paying customers from one video
```

At 5% trial-to-paid, 32 paying customers requires 640 trial starts.

Is that realistic from a 30k-subscriber video? That is the test.

LangoBee's unique asset

2,773 creators already in the database

The `youtube_creators` table in Supabase catalogs every creator whose content is in the app.

This is not a cold outreach list. These are creators:

- Whose content LangoBee's users are already watching
- Who can be told honestly: "your videos are already helping my users learn"
- Who have a verifiable audience fit before the first email is sent

This asset is unique. A competitor building a list from scratch spends weeks on research LangoBee can do in a SQL query.

(June 2026 snapshot: 17,440 texts, 98% video, 2,773 catalogued creators)

How to build a warm prospect list

The SQL query that turns the database into a prospecting asset:

```
SELECT
  creator_name,
  channel_url,
  COUNT(*)           AS clip_count,
  AVG(mean_zipf)     AS avg_difficulty
FROM texts
WHERE language = 'es'
  AND type = 'Video'
GROUP BY creator_name, channel_url
HAVING COUNT(*) >= 5
ORDER BY clip_count DESC
LIMIT 50;
```

Creators with 5+ clips have proven content volume. Sort by clip count to prioritize the most-represented channels.

What makes this opening line honest

Standard creator pitch: "I'd like to partner with you."

LangoBee's opening line: "Your videos are already in the app. Learners are watching them to study Spanish."

Why this is different:

- True: the content is in the catalog
- Specific: you can name the exact videos
- Reciprocal: you are bringing them something before asking for anything

Andrew Chen notes that clickthrough decay begins the moment an approach feels like an ad. An honest, specific opener resists that decay better than any promotional template.

(Chen, 2012)

"Over time, all marketing strategies result in shitty clickthrough rates."

Andrew Chen (2012)

The Law of Shitty Clickthroughs (andrewchen.com)

The Bullseye test for creator outreach

Before committing to any channel, it should pass the Bullseye test (Weinberg, 2015):

- Cost under \$1,000 to run the first test: a micro-creator flat fee fits
- Result visible within 30 days: a sponsorship video ships and converts (or does not) in weeks
- Single-channel focus: the outreach wave is one channel, not many

Creator outreach passes the Bullseye test at the micro tier. It fails at the macro tier unless the unit economics are first validated at small scale.

Take-aways

1. Language-learning YouTube concentrates your target audience more than any other channel. CI creators are the highest-signal segment.
2. Micro creators (10k-100k subscribers) offer the best cost-per-engaged-viewer for an early-stage app. Start there.
3. Market rates: flat-fee micro sponsorships run \$200-1,000. Affiliate commissions run 20-30%. CPM benchmarks are \$15-30 for niche content.
4. LangoBee's 2,773 catalogued creators are a warm prospecting asset no competitor has. Use the `youtube_creators` table before building any external list.
5. The Bullseye test: a micro-creator sponsorship costs under \$1,000 and produces results in 30 days. That is the right test size for an unvalidated channel.

What's next

- **Reading:** "Week 10: Sponsorship, affiliate, or equity-partner?" at </c/langobee-10k-mrr-26su/readings/wk10>
- **Lecture 2 (this week):** Partner, sponsor, or affiliate: what 50% buys and costs forever; FAST agreement norms; milestone-based alternatives
- **Section this week:** Build a 50-creator prospect list from the catalog; write and personalize the first five outreach emails
- **HW4 in flight, due week 11**